Chess Enrichment Program - Term 2

8-Week Curriculum Guide

Think. Play. Grow.

Beginner Level

Expanding knowledge: Building on basics with tactical patterns and game strategy

Week 1: Review & Piece Value

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Review all piece movements • Understand relative piece values • Make fair trades
Activities	• Piece value quiz games • Trading exercises • Capture the most valuable piece challenges
Superpower	Judgment - Making smart decisions

Week 2: Protecting Your Pieces

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Defend pieces from attacks • Create defensive chains • Recognize hanging pieces
Activities	• Find the unprotected piece puzzles • Defense building exercises • Hanging piece prevention drills
Superpower	Vigilance - Watching for danger

Week 3: Simple Tactics - The Fork

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Recognize fork patterns • Create fork opportunities • Defend against forks

Component	Description
Activities	• Knight fork puzzles • Pawn and queen fork challenges • Fork defense practice
Superpower	Sharpness - Spotting opportunities

Week 4: Controlling the Center

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Occupy central squares • Control center with pieces • Understand center dominance benefits
Activities	• Center control games • Central pawn structure drills • Center vs. flank battles
Superpower	Dominance - Taking control

Week 5: Basic Endgames

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• King and queen checkmate technique • Pawn promotion strategies • Basic king activity
Activities	• Checkmate the lone king drills • Pawn race games • Active king exercises
Superpower	Finishing - Completing what you start

Week 6: Chess Notation Basics

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Read simple chess notation • Record own moves • Follow game scores
Activities	• Notation learning games • Move recording practice • Replay notation exercises

Component	Description
Superpower	Documentation - Keeping records

Week 7: Planning Ahead

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Think 2-3 moves ahead • Create simple plans • Follow through on plans
Activities	• Multi-move puzzle sequences • Planning exercises • Goal-oriented games
Superpower	Foresight - Thinking ahead

Week 8: Term 2 Tournament

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Apply all term 2 concepts • Play longer games • Track improvement
Activities	• Round-robin tournament • Game analysis session • Term celebration
Superpower	Progress - Recognizing growth

Intermediate Level

Deepening understanding: Advanced tactics, strategic concepts, and opening repertoire

Week 1: Removal of the Defender

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Identify defending pieces • Execute removal tactics • Combine with other tactics
Activities	• Defender removal puzzles • Multi-step tactical sequences • Complex combinations
Superpower	Methodical Thinking - Breaking down problems

Week 2: Back Rank Weaknesses

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Recognize back rank threats • Exploit back rank weakness • Defend against back rank mates
Activities	• Back rank mate puzzles • Escape route creation • Prophylactic thinking exercises
Superpower	Anticipation - Preventing problems

Week 3: Queen vs. Two Rooks

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Compare piece power dynamics • Play endgames effectively • Understand compensation
Activities	• Queen vs. rooks endgames • Material imbalance games • Piece activity evaluation
Superpower	Evaluation - Assessing positions

Week 4: Pawn Structures Deep Dive

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Identify pawn structure types • Create favorable structures • Exploit opponent's weak pawns
Activities	• Structure recognition exercises • Pawn break identification • Structure transformation games
Superpower	Structural Thinking - Understanding frameworks

Week 5: Piece Coordination

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Coordinate pieces effectively • Create piece harmonies • Improve poorly placed pieces
Activities	• Coordination exercises • Piece improvement drills • Harmony vs. chaos positions
Superpower	Synergy - Making pieces work together

Week 6: Attacking the King

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Recognize attacking chances • Bring pieces into attack • Calculate forcing sequences
Activities	• King attack patterns • Attacking combinations • Sacrifice for attack puzzles
Superpower	Aggression - Calculated boldness

Week 7: Opening Repertoire Building

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Develop white opening • Prepare black defenses • Understand opening principles deeply

Component	Description
Activities	• Repertoire planning • Opening traps to know • Thematic games in chosen openings
Superpower	Preparation - Coming ready

Week 8: Rated Tournament

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Compete in serious tournament • Handle tournament pressure • Analyze games afterward
Activities	• 4-round Swiss tournament • Post-game analysis • Rating calculation and celebration
Superpower	Competitive Spirit - Embracing challenges

Advanced Level

Refinement: Dynamic play, deep calculation, and competitive excellence

Week 1: Dynamic Imbalances

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Evaluate positions with imbalances • Trade advantages appropriately • Play for compensation
Activities	• Imbalance identification • Piece vs. pawn dynamics • Complex evaluation exercises
Superpower	Sophistication - Understanding complexity

Week 2: Prophylactic Thinking

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Prevent opponent's ideas • Improve position quietly • Master waiting moves
Activities	• Prophylaxis identification • Improving worst piece challenges • Strategic maneuvering games
Superpower	Restraint - Knowing when to wait

Week 3: Weak Squares & Outposts

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Create and exploit weak squares • Establish dominant outposts • Prevent opponent's outposts
Activities	• Weak square identification • Outpost creation exercises • Blockade strategies
Superpower	Exploitation - Using weaknesses

Week 4: Calculation Training

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Calculate 5+ moves deep • Visualize positions accurately • Prune candidate moves efficiently
Activities	• Deep calculation exercises • Blindfold position recognition • Candidate move selection drills
Superpower	Concentration - Deep focus

Week 5: Endgame Mastery

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Master opposite-colored bishops • Understand fortress positions • Play queen endgames
Activities	• OCB endgame studies • Drawing resources exercises • Queen endgame technique
Superpower	Technique - Executing precisely

Week 6: Opening Preparation

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Study opponent's games • Prepare novelties • Build opening database
Activities	• Game database study • Preparation routines • Opening surprise implementation
Superpower	Research - Doing homework

Week 7: Time Management

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Allocate time effectively • Recognize critical moments • Play accurately under time pressure

Component	Description
Activities	• Time control practice • Critical position identification • Blitz with analysis
Superpower	Time Awareness - Managing the clock

Week 8: Championship Event

Component	Description
Learning Goals	• Peak performance competition • Demonstrate all skills • Achieve rating goals
Activities	• Major tournament (6 rounds) • Live game commentary • Championship celebration
Superpower	Peak Performance - Playing your best